Léo Jean

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CIRED, 45 bis avenue de la Belle Gabrielle, 94130 Nogent-sur-Marne, France

Fields

Primary Environmental Economics, Energy Economics
Secondary Natural Resource Economics, Industrial Organization of Energy Markets

Current Position

CNRS – CIRED *2026 – 2027*
Postdoctoral researcher, with Adrien Fabre

References

Fanny Henriet (supervisor)
CNRS, Aix-Marseille School of Economics
fanny.henriet@gmail.com

Renaud Coulomb
CERNA, École des Mines Paris-PSL
renaud.coulomb@minesparis.psl.eu

Julien Daubanes
DTU and MIT CEEPR
jxada@dtu.dk

Lassi Ahlvik
University of Helsinki
lassi.ahlvik@helsinki.fi

Education

Ph.D., Economics, Paris School of Economics *2021 – 2026*

Thesis: *Essays on Climate Policy and Heterogeneous Oil Resources*

Supervisor: Fanny Henriet (CNRS, AMSE)

Jury: Anna Créti (Université Paris Dauphine-PSL, president), Lassi Ahlvik (University of Helsinki, reviewer), Gilles Lafforgue (TBS, reviewer), Mar Reguant (IAE-CSIC and Northwestern University), Julien Daubanes (Technical University of Denmark). Defended 29 April 2026.

M.S., International Relations and Security Policy, Toulouse-I Capitole *2020 – 2021*

M.S., Economics: Public Policy and Development, Paris School of Economics *2018 – 2020*

École Normale Supérieure Paris-Saclay *2017 – 2021*
Full fellowship (*élève-fonctionnaire normalien*)

Research Visits

Technical University of Denmark, Copenhagen *Jan – Jun 2026; Apr – Jun 2024*
Host: Julien Daubanes

McGill University, Montreal *Sep – Dec 2025*
Host: Hassan Benchekroun

University of Melbourne *Apr – Jul 2019*
Research intern; supervisor: Renaud Coulomb

Working Papers

The Price of Delay: Oil Field Lock-In and Delayed Carbon Pricing
Job Market Paper.
Previously circulated as "The long-term cost of delaying carbon taxation in the oil sector".

Oil projects involve large development costs and comparatively low operating costs to produce. Once development costs are sunk, a carbon tax high enough to have deterred a project can be too low to stop its production, so that delaying climate policy locks in emissions that the delayed policy can no longer remove. Existing models of oil supply give each field a single cost per barrel, which rules this lock-in out. I separate the decision to develop a field from the decision to keep it producing for 25,336 oil fields covering the world's reserves. Delaying a 1.5°C-aligned carbon tax from 2016 to 2030 overshoots the oil carbon budget by a fifth, mostly through overproduction during the delay. A 2030 tax calibrated with existing models misses the emissions locked in during the delay: it overshoots the remaining budget by 13 $GtCO_2eq$, 10% of that budget, although it is only 3.5% too low. Almost half of this overshoot would remain even if investors had correctly expected the tax in 2030. Because locked-in fields barely respond to a higher tax, meeting the budget strands other producers instead, thus redistributing the cost of the delay. Lock-in is concentrated in a few hundred capital-intensive projects, mostly offshore, so that targeted bans can remove nearly half of it.

Voice Until the Last Exit: Ownership Structure and the Limits of Voluntary Environmental Commitments, *with Sanjana Ghosh and Pritam Saha*

The effectiveness of corporate climate initiatives depends not only on firms' commitments but also on existing asset ownership structures. We study this question in the context of the World Bank's Zero Routine Flaring by 2030 initiative, under which oil and gas companies pledge to eliminate routine flaring from their assets. Using asset-level ownership and satellite-based flaring measurements for nearly 20,000 oil and gas assets worldwide (2012–2024), we exploit staggered firm endorsements to study how committed firms navigate the tradeoff between voice, exercising governance influence to reduce emissions, and exit, divesting from assets that are costly to decarbonize. Committed ownership reduces flaring gradually but persistently, reaching approximately 45% below pre-commitment levels after nine years. The persistence of these gains hinges on continued committed presence: when the last committed owner divests, flaring rises by roughly 40% within two years and exceeds 90% within six years, a result we term the "last good owner effect." Retaining at least one committed voice on the board is both necessary and sufficient to sustain emissions discipline.

Work in Progress

The Climate-wise Values of Oil, *with Renaud Coulomb and Fanny Henriet*

Oil and Risk, *with Helena Cordt, Julien Daubanes and Yiding Ma*

Cartels and Oil Prices in the Event of a Climate Coalition, *with Adrien Fabre*

Teaching

Université Paris-1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, Teaching Assistant (undergraduate)

Institutions: Employment, Unemployment and Wages *Spring 2025*
Introduction to Economics *Fall 2024*

Conferences and Presentations

2026 NAERE Workshop (Stockholm); World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists (WCERE, Lisbon); FAERE (Dijon); CEPR Symposium (Paris, *scheduled*)

2025 Columbia IPWSD (New York); NAERE Workshop (Copenhagen); CREEA Annual Conference (Winnipeg)

2024 EAERE Annual Conference (Leuven); DTU Internal Seminar (Copenhagen)

2023 IAEE European Conference (Milan); IOEA Summer School (Cargèse); PSI-PSE Doctoral Seminar (Paris)

Grants and Fellowships

MITACS Globalink Research Award *(Can$6000)*	*2025*
PSE Mobility Grant *(2550€)*	*2025*
Mobility Grant, PSE – REM group *(2000€)*	*2024*
Doctoral Fellowship (Contrat Doctoral Spécifique Normalien), ENS	*2021 – 2024*
Full Fellowship, ENS Paris-Saclay (*élève-fonctionnaire normalien*)	*2017 – 2021*

Skills

Languages French (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Software R, QGIS, LaTeX; working knowledge of Python and Julia

Last updated: October 2026